

Nurlan Utesov

utesov@wisc.edu | nutesov.github.io | aae.wisc.edu/grad-students/utesov

Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison
519 Taylor Hall, 427 Lorch St., Madison, WI 53706

EDUCATION

- 2020 – present Ph.D. Candidate, Agricultural and Applied Economics, **University of Wisconsin–Madison**
(expected May 2027)
Dissertation: *Power Without Information: Essays on Taxation, Technology and the Farm*
Committee: Paul Mitchell (chair), Paul Castañeda Dower, Guanming Shi
- 2017 – 2019 M.A. in Economics, **New Economic School**, Moscow
- 2011 – 2015 B.Sc. in Economics, **Moscow State University**

FIELDS

- Primary Political economy, economic history, development, public economics
- Secondary Industrial organization

WORKING PAPERS

Power Without Information: The Human Cost of Uniform Land Taxation in Subsistence Agriculture
[Job Market Paper], draft September 2026

A state that cannot verify the harvest it taxes chooses between a crop share, which invites a reporting game between the farm and the assessor, and a fixed rent per hectare, which cannot be moved by a report of the harvest and cannot follow it: a fixed rent taxes uniformly farms whose harvests differ. In January 1933 the Soviet state replaced its claim on the assessed grain harvest of collective farms with a fixed rent per sown hectare, one rate for every farm of a district. On the accounts of 272 collective farms of the Urals for 1933 and 1934, I measure what uniform taxation cost in people and divide the cost between information and incentives. The sequence of the agricultural year fixes what each party observed when it acted and hence the form of each claim; the rules estimated from the accounts, the district office's schedule, the farm's division of grain between seed and food, the seed relief and the response of population to food, convert any schedule of deliveries into members a year later. Relative to the same statutory total allocated on harvests with subsistence first, the policy as run cost 4,392 people, one member in twenty-eight: 707 from taxing uniformly farms whose harvests differed, 2,755 from the level of the wedge, the offices' collection above the norm, and 930 from its allocation across farms the office could not tell apart. Relief that came as seed in the spring rather than food in the autumn cost a further 964.

Taxing What the State Could See: The Design of Soviet Grain Procurement and the Famine of 1933, draft September 2026

A state that cannot verify its producers' harvest taxes what it can see. Soviet grain procurement of 1932 was written on the sown area, on past deliveries and on a yield assessed from the standing crop, and it was collected by local officials who answered for a district's quota. This paper asks whether that tax, as it was actually collected, was enough to produce the famine of 1933. In the state's own post-harvest surveys of collective farms, recorded by region, the harvest of 1932 was in most regions enough to feed the farms' members; after the state's claims most of their farms fell below subsistence, and the depth of the shortfall predicts the rise in mortality between regions under every allocation of food within a region that the printed distributions admit. Ukraine, where the famine struck hardest, lost no more to the extraction than the other grain-producing regions, and the schedules make no reference to nationality. Within regions, districts with

more Ukrainians had higher mortality, a difference the regional data cannot test; the archives point to the local campaigns of enforcement, the conditioning of relief and the restriction of movement, which no survey measures.

Victory over Peasantry: Extractive Institutions and the Big Push (with Vladimir Gimpelson and Paul Castañeda Dower), draft March 2026

Examines how Big Push policies perform under the constraints of extractive institutions. Using novel micro-data from an All-Union audit of collective farms, we exploit the rollout of Machine Tractor Stations (MTS), the central pillar of Soviet agricultural policy, to estimate the impact of mechanization on collective farm performance, state procurement and peasant welfare in the early Soviet command economy. The Soviet-MTS system rapidly expanded technological adoption but failed to realize the full gains of increasing returns to scale technologies; adoption also did not raise living standards, leaving peasants on mechanized farms at or below subsistence levels.

Technology, Contracts, and Coordination: Modernizing Agricultural Supply Chains in Wisconsin Potatoes, draft October 2025

Examines how technology adoption and contractual coordination jointly modernize an agricultural supply chain, using the Wisconsin fresh potato industry (2010–2019), where a wholesaler invested in optical sorting systems and then entered long-term marketing contracts with a retail chain. A random-coefficients demand model and a difference-in-differences design show that the sorting technology lowered marginal cost by about 4.6 cents per pound (roughly 10% of the price) and that the contracts added about 1.5 cents to price-cost margins, with the gains reinforced by improved inventory management and reduced spoilage.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Repression and the collective farm in the Urals, 1930–1934 (data in progress): a registry of the persons dispossessed or disenfranchised in the Ural region, built from the district archives, matched to the 1928 settlement census and to the farm accounts, and being completed from the local archives.
- A district panel of the state's agricultural policy across the Urals through the 1930s, extended year by year.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2026: Economic History Association (EHA) Annual Meeting (St. Louis, MO), poster — *Power Without Information: The Human Cost of Uniform Land Taxation in Subsistence Agriculture*
- 2026: Summer Workshop in the Economic History and Historical Political Economy of Russia (University of Chicago Center in Paris) — *Multiple Principals: Uncoordinated State Extraction and Misallocation in Soviet Agriculture, 1933–1934*
- 2025: Central Asian Economics Conference (Almaty, Kazakhstan) — *Relational Contracts and Technology Adoption in Agricultural Supply Chains*
- 2024: Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting (New Orleans, LA) — *Local Premium Quality Foods and Marketing Contracts in the Wisconsin Fresh Potato Market*
- 2023: Economic History Association (EHA) Annual Meeting (Philadelphia, PA) — *Victory Over Village: Failed State-Led Agricultural Modernization*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, UW–Madison

2020 – present

Digitization of Soviet farm-level and regional records of the 1930s (collective-farm annual reports, the state's post-harvest surveys of collective farms, district handbooks); supply chain modernization in the Wisconsin potato industry.

Research Assistant, Université de Namur (Belgium)

2019

Clans and politics in Kyrgyzstan (PIs: Gani Aldashev, Catherine Guirkinger).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, New Economic School

2018 – 2019

Macroeconomics I & II (M.A. Program)

Teaching Assistant, Higher School of Economics

2017

Microeconomics I (B.A. Program)

FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS, AND AWARDS

- Erasmus Grant, Université de Namur, 2019
- Petr Aven Scholarship, New Economic School, 2018 (academic excellence)
- National and Regional Competition Awards, 2009–2010 (Economics, Social Science, History, Mathematics, Physics)

SKILLS

Econometrics & Programming Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, QGIS

Languages English (fluent), Russian (native), Japanese (intermediate), French (beginner)

REFERENCES

Paul Mitchell (chair), Professor, Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison. pdmitchell@wisc.edu

Paul Castañeda Dower, Associate Professor, Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison. pdower@wisc.edu

Guanming Shi, Professor, Department of Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison. gshi@wisc.edu

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